OUTFILE

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FROM FOREIGN OFFICE TO PARIS

No. 1719
20th November, 1951.

D. 8.50 p.m. 20th November, 1951.

PRIORITY
SECRET

Addressed to Paris telegram No. 1719 of 20th November.
Repeated for information to: Washington, Tokyo, Peking, Singapore, and Taipei.

My telegram No. 1704 [November 19th: Japan and Formosa.]

Please pass following personal message to Mr. Acheson.

[Begins]

I much appreciate frankness with which the United States Government have consulted us over this problem and I strongly agree on the importance of our maintaining a common front towards Japan as we have done on other questions throughout the Peace Treaty negotiations.

2. On full consideration, however, I do not feel able to approve the draft formula which emerged from the official-level talks in London last week. My predecessor and Mr. Dulles agreed in June last that Japan's future attitude towards China must be for determination by Japan itself in the exercise of the sovereign and independent status contemplated by the Peace Treaty. I stand by this agreement. I recognise that there are trade relations and other practical questions which may require contacts between the Japanese Government and the Chinese Nationalists. It would be one thing for the Japanese Government, should they so desire, to take preliminary steps aimed at a modus vivendi covering these matters. I would not wish to discourage this. It would be quite another thing for Japan to embark on any form of recognition of the Chinese Nationalists, and if need arose I should feel bound to endorse the advice already given the Japanese Government by Sir E. Dening against this action. I cannot help feeling that any such action might add to Japan's and our difficulties in the future.

/3. In answering

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3. In answering your proposal on these lines, I would not wish to be thought unconscious of the probable difficulties in regard to the ratification of the Peace Treaty in the United States Senate. We must, however, also consider the Parliamentary situation in this country and I should be most reluctant to do anything to jeopardise the bi-partisan acceptance which the Japanese Peace Settlement has so far received in Parliament.

[Ends].

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